

The success of your venture would depend on the knowledge that you have. You could start from basic familiarisation courses with the PC and go on to training in different programs such as Web designing, multimedia, and perhaps even programming.

All you need is a computer and a desire to teach—you could even end up owning a computer training conglomerate!

How much can you earn?

This would differ according to what you are teaching, whether it's basic computer skills or programming. You could charge by the hour or one amount for a certain number of sessions.

8 Using gadgets/software

Do you have a CD-Writer or a scanner that's underutilised? Why not use it to recover the investment which you made while buying them? You could do this for people who need to back up data on CDs but don't have CD-Writers, or for people who need images scanned and burned on to a CD. And there are many such people.

Along with



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COPYWRITER

“Copywriting using my PC is really easy. I can work with different fonts and find out which font works best and has the best impact. The art director too can just layout the copy after I've written it”

scanning pictures for others, you can offer to clean and spruce up the image too, maybe resize and add effects for CD covers and such like (you'll need a comfortable knowledge of image editing software for this), and charge a little extra money for all the services rendered.

You could even burn freeware or shareware but make sure it's not protected by copyright as in the case of music or software. Taking back ups of data from a hard disk on to a CD is another option. You'll need to be a little hardware savvy to be able to plug in another hard disk into your computer and back up the data onto a CD.

How much can you earn?

You could charge anything between

Where do I look for work?

Once you've decided what to do, the next step is looking for work and getting customers.

■ The best way to find work is through word of mouth. Spread the word among your friends and people you know about the services you're offering and you'll be surprised at how effectively it works.

■ Take your work online. You could have your portfolio or work samples displayed on a Web site. If you're a writer, sending out newsletters to a few people you know

containing useful articles or links to your work could get people acquainted with your work and help you get clients.

■ Use the Net or search engines to ferret out forums and Web sites specific to what you want to do such as sites for designers, programmers, data entry or DTP operators. You could post your advertisement or find people who need work done. www.workathome15.homestead.com and www.homebiznews.com are sites where you could post an ad or get ideas on how you can make money off the Net.

Rs 80-100 to burn a single CD. As for scanning, Rs 10-20 is more like it.

9 Programming and technical services

If you have programming skills and want to work from home either full time or part time, you'll find lots of companies willing to outsource you work. The kind of programming that you'll be doing will depend on your skillsets, languages known, level of expertise, and experience.

Plenty of small to medium-sized companies outsource technical work at

could earn between Rs 2,000-4,000, while for application programming projects of similar length, you could make between Rs 4,000-8,000.

10 Medical transcription

If you have a background in medicine and are well-versed with medical terminology, medical transcription is a lucrative option that you could pursue. This is the process of translating digitised audio medical records and dictation by physicians into accurate text records.

You also need to have the ability to understand different types of accents. Excellent English language skills, good hearing acuity and listening ability, reasonable keyboard skills and ability to work for long hours with a high level of concentration are some of the key attributes.

Transcription at home isn't for everyone. Apart from your PC and a word processor, you'll need to invest in reference material such as a good medical dictionary or a physicians' desk reference. You'll also need audio equipment for transcription. It's best to start working with a company and after gaining experience, move on to the next step of working from home.

How much can you earn?

These jobs are usually handed out by institutes handling medical transcription. You could earn between Rs 8,000-10,000 per month.

AVINA LOBO

